

PTO Project – Context and Leadership Escalation Timeline

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Purpose: Transparency and leadership alignment regarding recent escalation discussions.

Executive Summary

This document provides context and a timeline of recent leadership discussions and escalation topics related to the PTO project Technical Lead role.

Since the leadership transition in October 2025, multiple discussions have occurred regarding leadership expectations, communication style, and team engagement. These discussions have involved several management levels and have included extended feedback meetings and escalation conversations.

In parallel, the PTO project is approaching important delivery milestones, including the upcoming GA release. Several technical incidents during this period also involved differences in interpretation regarding requirement clarity and issue classification.

The purpose of this document is to provide a transparent summary of these events, clarify the technical and organizational context, and request leadership guidance to ensure alignment moving forward.

My goal is to continue supporting the PTO project effectively while maintaining focus on delivery quality, technical leadership responsibilities, and team stability.

1. Background

I currently serve as the **Technical Lead for the PTO (Pipeline Take-Off) project**.

My responsibilities include:

- Technical architecture and system integrity
- Code review and technical risk identification
- Integration between PTO and LBM systems
- Technical planning and delivery oversight
- Supporting the development team of 5 engineers

The PTO team includes:

- Business Analyst
- DevOps
- QA
- Scrum Master
- 5 developers

The current system architecture includes:

The PTO development team has worked together continuously for **nearly four years**, with the same core developers remaining on the project.

This stability has helped maintain strong product knowledge and consistent delivery.

2. Change in Leadership Context

Until **September 2025**, the PTO project worked under Dev Manager **Sravan**, and the technical leadership structure was stable.

In **October 2025**, Dev Manager **Chris Miller** joined and new expectations were introduced regarding leadership, communication style, and ownership.

Since that time, a number of discussions and escalation conversations have occurred related to leadership expectations and communication style.

This document summarizes the key events and context.

3. Key Timeline of Events (Reverse Chronological Order)

Date	Event	Description
Mar 2 – Mar 6, 2026	Multiple leadership feedback meetings	Several 1-on-1 and leadership meetings were held discussing leadership improvement topics such as communication style, technical transparency, and team

		engagement. Some meetings lasted 1–2 hours and occurred repeatedly within the same week.
Mar 5, 2026	Leadership improvement meeting	Meeting with Chris Miller, Thi Anh Ho, and Thuat Nghia Bui discussing improvement expectations for the Technical Lead role.
Feb 24, 2026	Off-hours reporting request	Additional report preparation requested after working hours to support leadership reporting discussions.
Feb 16 – Feb 20, 2026	Vietnam Lunar New Year holiday	Vietnam team was on official holiday with limited development capacity. As Technical Lead, I continued to follow project communications and supported the US team during this period when needed to ensure the PTO project remained stable.
Feb 13, 2026	PTO-26355 issue escalation discussion	A change request was initially raised as a defect and required immediate resolution before the holiday

		period. The development team identified technical risks and unclear requirements and recommended postponing implementation until requirements were clarified. Issue occurred before Lunar New Year. Although on planned leave, I returned to support investigation and provide RCA. The team identified the issue as requirement clarification rather than a simple defect and recommended postponing changes due to technical risk before the holiday period.
Feb 12, 2026	Root cause analysis prepared	Despite planned leave, I returned to work to provide technical explanation, risk analysis, and RCA documentation for the issue.
Feb 2, 2026	An infrastructure-related issue involving SSL certificate renewal	Initial concerns were escalated before the technical root cause and scope of

	was raised during this period.	responsibility were fully clarified. After further investigation and discussion with the Dev Manager, it became clear that the issue was related to scope ownership rather than an operational failure. This situation highlighted the importance of ensuring that technical root cause and ownership are clearly established before escalation or performance-related conclusions are considered.
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4. Feb 12–13 Technical Incident Context

One of the key escalation points occurred around Feb 12–13, shortly before the Lunar New Year holiday.

The issue involved **PTO-26355**, which was initially reported as a bug.

Although I had planned leave during this period, I returned to support the investigation and provided a technical explanation and root cause analysis for the issue.

After technical investigation, the development team concluded that the issue was related to **business logic interpretation and requirement clarification**, rather than a simple defect.

Technical concerns included:

- risk of incorrect calculations
- unclear requirement interpretation
- possible regression impact on existing functionality

Given the limited development capacity before the holiday and the potential risk of introducing regression issues, the Vietnam team recommended:

- clarifying the final requirement with the Product Owner
- implementing the change safely after the holiday
- avoiding rushed modification before a multi-day team absence

The technical explanation and analysis were shared with stakeholders during the discussion.

Despite the technical explanation and documentation provided, the discussion later evolved into a broader conversation regarding team ownership and leadership expectations.

5. Leadership Feedback Themes

During recent leadership discussions, feedback was shared by several leaders regarding expectations for the Technical Lead role within the PTO project.

The following summarizes the key themes communicated.

Chris Miller – Key Feedback

Chris emphasized several areas where leadership improvements were expected from the Technical Lead role.

Key themes included:

- **Increasing regular engagement with team members**, including more frequent check-ins to better understand team blockers, well-being, and potential quality concerns.
- **Improving transparency in technical decisions**, particularly by clearly explaining the reasoning behind technical approaches in order to help the team understand the context and gain stronger alignment.
- **Maintaining strong focus on delivery quality**, especially with regard to the critical PTO GA milestone planned for Q1.
- **Encouraging stronger team motivation and engagement**, including helping the team remain energized and positive about upcoming initiatives such as the potential React and TypeScript migration planned for later phases of the project.

These expectations were discussed across multiple meetings and were framed as opportunities for leadership improvement.

Thi Anh Ho – Key Feedback

Thi shared feedback primarily related to communication and team collaboration.

Key themes included:

- Improving communication clarity by presenting ideas more directly and clearly defining expectations when discussing technical solutions.
 - Building stronger mutual trust with team members by demonstrating confidence in their capabilities and decision-making.
 - Increasing collaboration with team members when addressing technical challenges rather than attempting to resolve issues independently.
 - Ensuring strong team coordination during critical periods, including establishing appropriate monitoring and alerting mechanisms before important release windows.
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Thuat Nghia Bui – Key Feedback

Thuat's feedback focused primarily on leadership responsibility and transparency.

Key themes included:

- Maintaining transparent and consistent communication with the team.
- Providing clearer leadership direction while remaining open about knowledge gaps when necessary.
- Ensuring proper recognition of team contributions and highlighting the work of team members when solutions are presented to stakeholders.
- Strengthening team ownership and urgency regarding both short-term deliverables and longer-term project goals.
- Inspiring the team by communicating the broader vision and value of their work within the organization

6. Leadership Feedback Process

During the recent leadership discussions, leadership feedback sessions were organized and facilitated by the Vietnam regional leadership team.

These discussions included input gathered from individual team members and were later referenced during meetings involving multiple leadership levels.

Because these discussions were conducted separately with team members, I did not have full visibility into the original context of the feedback being referenced.

In several meetings, feedback collected from individual team members was presented as part of leadership escalation discussions regarding communication style, leadership approach, and team engagement.

While feedback from team members is valuable and important for leadership development, the indirect nature of these discussions sometimes made it difficult to fully understand the original context in which the comments were provided.

For clarity and transparency, it may be beneficial if leadership feedback discussions include:

- shared examples
- direct discussion with involved parties
- alignment conversations involving both leadership and team members

This approach may help ensure that feedback is clearly understood, constructive, and aligned across all stakeholders.

In some discussions, leadership feedback referenced perspectives gathered from individual team members regarding the Technical Lead role.

7. Workload and Meeting Impact

During the week of **March 2–6**, several extended meetings were held related to leadership improvement discussions.

Examples include:

Date	Meeting Duration
Mar 2	16:25 – 18:55
Mar 3	~18:00 – 19:00
Mar 5	Leadership meeting with 3 managers
Mar 5	Additional follow-up meeting
Mar 8 (Sunday afternoon)	Actions plans

While I fully support leadership feedback and improvement discussions, the frequency and length of these meetings significantly reduced time available for:

- technical leadership
- project planning
- development coordination
- PTO GA delivery preparation.

8. Personal Impact

Over the past weeks, the combination of:

- Repeated escalation discussions
- extended leadership meetings
- additional reporting work outside working hours

has created a significant level of stress and reduced the time available for core technical responsibilities.

My intention in documenting this information is not to assign blame, but to ensure transparency and request guidance on how to address these challenges constructively.

9. Objective of This Documentation

The purpose of this document is to:

- provide a transparent timeline of events
- clarify technical and communication context
- ensure leadership alignment
- support constructive discussion with management

My goal remains to continue contributing effectively to the PTO project and ensure the successful delivery of upcoming milestones.

10. Supporting Evidence

Relevant communication and documentation include:

- PTO Daily Meeting Recap – Feb 13
- Email thread regarding PTO issue escalation
- PTO bugs analysis discussion
- SSL certificate renewal email thread

11. Organizational Risk and Alignment Considerations

Based on the events described above, several organizational considerations may arise if the current situation continues without alignment.

The intention of highlighting these points is to ensure the long-term success of the PTO project and maintain a healthy engineering environment.

Technical leadership focus

The PTO project is currently approaching important delivery milestones, including the upcoming GA release.

In recent weeks, a significant portion of time has been spent on repeated escalation discussions and leadership feedback meetings.

This reduces the time available for key Technical Lead responsibilities, including:

- technical architecture oversight
- technical risk assessment
- code review and quality assurance
- coordination between PTO and LBM systems

Ensuring sufficient focus on these responsibilities will be important for maintaining delivery quality and project stability.

Issue classification and technical alignment

Some recent incidents suggest differences in interpretation between:

- product expectations
- management expectations
- technical evaluation by the development team

In certain cases, issues initially classified as **defects** were later determined to involve **requirement clarification or design interpretation**.

Without clear alignment on issue classification and resolution processes, this may lead to:

- confusion regarding quality metrics
- repeated escalation discussions
- increased pressure on engineering teams

Establishing clearer shared definitions may help reduce future misunderstandings.

Cross-region communication differences

The PTO project involves collaboration across multiple regions, including:

- Vietnam engineering team
- US product and engineering leadership

Communication styles may differ across regions.

For example:

- Vietnam engineers may communicate more cautiously or indirectly
- US leadership expectations may emphasize more direct communication and proactive engagement

Without clear alignment, these differences may unintentionally be interpreted as leadership or ownership concerns.

Improving shared understanding between teams may help reduce potential misinterpretation.

Team stability and morale

The PTO engineering team has remained stable for nearly **four years**, with the same core developers working on the project since its early stages.

This stability has contributed to:

- strong domain knowledge
- long-term product ownership
- efficient collaboration within the team

However, repeated escalation discussions and uncertainty around leadership expectations may affect team confidence if not addressed with clear alignment.

Maintaining clarity in leadership structure and expectations will be important to preserve team stability and productivity.

Leadership alignment

Recent discussions have involved multiple leadership levels, including:

- Development Manager
- Regional Manager
- Director

Ensuring consistent alignment across these levels may help:

- reduce repeated escalation cycles
- provide clearer expectations for the Technical Lead role
- support more efficient decision-making within the PTO project.

Structured leadership feedback

Constructive leadership feedback is valuable and necessary.

However, when feedback discussions occur frequently without a clearly defined improvement framework, it may become difficult to:

- prioritize improvement areas
- measure progress
- maintain focus on delivery responsibilities

A more structured leadership development approach, with defined objectives and review checkpoints, may help ensure that feedback discussions remain constructive and measurable.

12. Good Faith Efforts to Address Concerns

Before preparing this document, I made several efforts to address leadership feedback through ongoing discussions with my managers.

These efforts included participating in multiple one-on-one meetings, providing technical explanations for incidents such as PTO-26355, and supporting additional reporting requests related to escalation discussions.

My intention has been to understand the feedback and improve my leadership approach while continuing to support the technical responsibilities of the PTO project.

This document is intended to provide transparency and request leadership guidance, rather than to raise a complaint about any individual.

13. Request for Leadership Guidance

The intention of documenting the events and context described in this page is to provide transparency and ensure alignment across leadership levels.

My goal is to continue contributing effectively to the PTO project while maintaining a healthy and productive engineering environment.

Given the situations described above, I would appreciate guidance from leadership on several areas that may help improve alignment moving forward.

Clarification of the Technical Lead role

Over the past months, the expectations for the Technical Lead role appear to include both:

- technical leadership responsibilities
- broader leadership and communication expectations

Clearer alignment on the balance between these responsibilities may help ensure that priorities remain consistent with project needs.

This would allow the Technical Lead role to focus effectively on:

- technical architecture oversight
- delivery quality
- cross-system integration coordination
- risk identification and mitigation

while continuing to improve leadership and communication practices.

Alignment on escalation and issue evaluation

Recent incidents suggest that there may be different interpretations regarding:

- issue classification (defect vs. requirement clarification)
- escalation thresholds
- technical risk assessment

Establishing clearer alignment on these processes may help ensure that:

- engineering decisions are evaluated consistently
 - escalation cycles are minimized
 - teams can focus on delivery and technical quality.
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Constructive leadership improvement framework

Leadership feedback is valuable and important for growth.

To ensure that improvement discussions remain constructive and measurable, it may be helpful to establish:

- clearly defined improvement objectives
- measurable milestones or checkpoints
- periodic review discussions rather than repeated escalation conversations

This structure may help ensure that feedback discussions lead to clear progress while allowing sufficient time for project responsibilities.

Maintaining team stability and delivery focus

The PTO project is approaching important delivery milestones, including the GA release.

Ensuring stable leadership alignment and minimizing organizational uncertainty will help the team maintain focus on:

- delivery quality
 - technical stability
 - cross-team coordination.
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I remain committed to supporting the PTO project and contributing to the success of the engineering organization.

I welcome leadership guidance on how best to address the alignment considerations described in this document.

These materials provide additional technical context for the events described above. [Fw_ PTO Bugs.eml](#) [Re_ PTO Issues.eml](#) [Re_ Leadership feedback - Liem Nguyen.eml](#) [Re_ \[ACTION REQUIRED\] Requested Item RITM0072876_ Certificate Enrollment Renewal Request \(Approv](#)

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